

First LCD television

In 1988, Sharp Corporation introduced the first commercial 14-inch LCD TV

First OLED Television

Sony Corporation unveiled the first 11-inch OLED TV 'XEL-1' back in 2007 which was only 3-mm thick

By Nimish Sawant
nimish.sawant@thinkdigit.com

Liquid Crystal Display (LCD) has become the de-facto standard for desktop monitors. You rarely see Cathode Ray Tubes (CRTs) in the new system configurations. Not only have the prices of LCD monitors dropped from the stratospheric levels they were touching just a couple of years ago, the market is also flooded with them. Jargon and specifications are thrown around to further confuse the buyer. Are LED monitors better than

LCD ones? What panel should I look for? Does higher specified dynamic contrast ratio equate to a great monitor? These are just some of the queries that bother a buyer before making the decision.

We decided to pit 21 monitors from as many as 10 companies against each other to help you decide your next monitor purchase.

Let's jump right in. There's no such thing as an LED TV. Period. If you replace the CCFL (cold cathode fluorescent lamps) backlight in an LCD monitor with LED, you get an LED backlit LCD monitor.

The immediate advantage of replacing CCFL with LED is a slimmer profile of the monitor and also the power circuitry can be kept in the power brick which can be attached separately to the monitor unlike in CCFL-backlit LCD monitors where the power circuitry is within the monitor.

Most of the LCD panels in the market are Twisted Neumatic (TN) panels; they're affordable and easy to manufacture, have good response time and ideal for gamers and regular users. But TN panels offer poor viewing angles as compared to the other two.

Next is the Vertical Alignment (VA) panel technology, that is better than TN in terms of viewing angles, a wider colour gamut and better black levels giving higher contrast ratios. VA panels' response time is slower than TN panels.

In-Plane Switching (IPS) panel technology is the most superior amongst the three as it offers close to 178 degrees viewing angles, better colour reproduction but poor response times. IPS panels are best suited for photographers or designers who are looking for accurate colours and not meant for gamers.

Liquid Crystal Meth

Twenty-one monitors fight it off to the finish so you can choose the best fit for your system

